



DISTROBOX to login linux with uniform ROS code
↳ to pull the "image" and have all installation
and libraries of ROS → same environment...



POLITECNICO
MILANO 1863



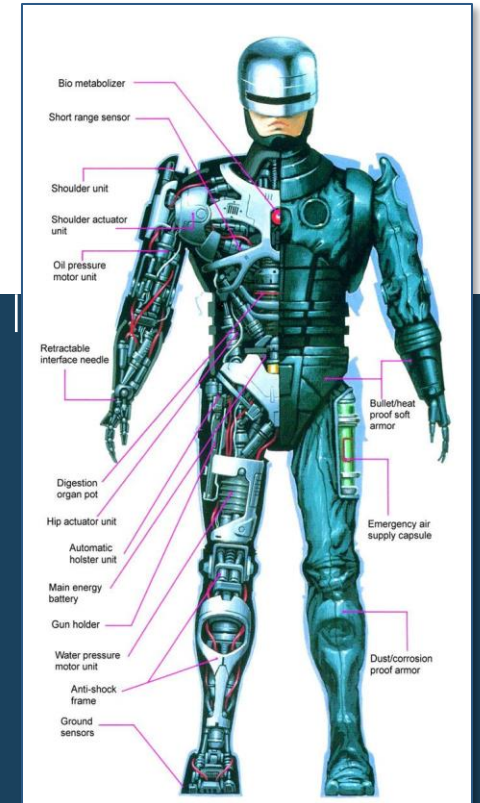
POLITECNICO
MILANO 1863

→ how to measure position/velocity
(Perception / Mapping / Localization) ⇒ SENSORS importance
+ overview of
ACTUATOR
used for motion
like electrical motors

←

Robotics

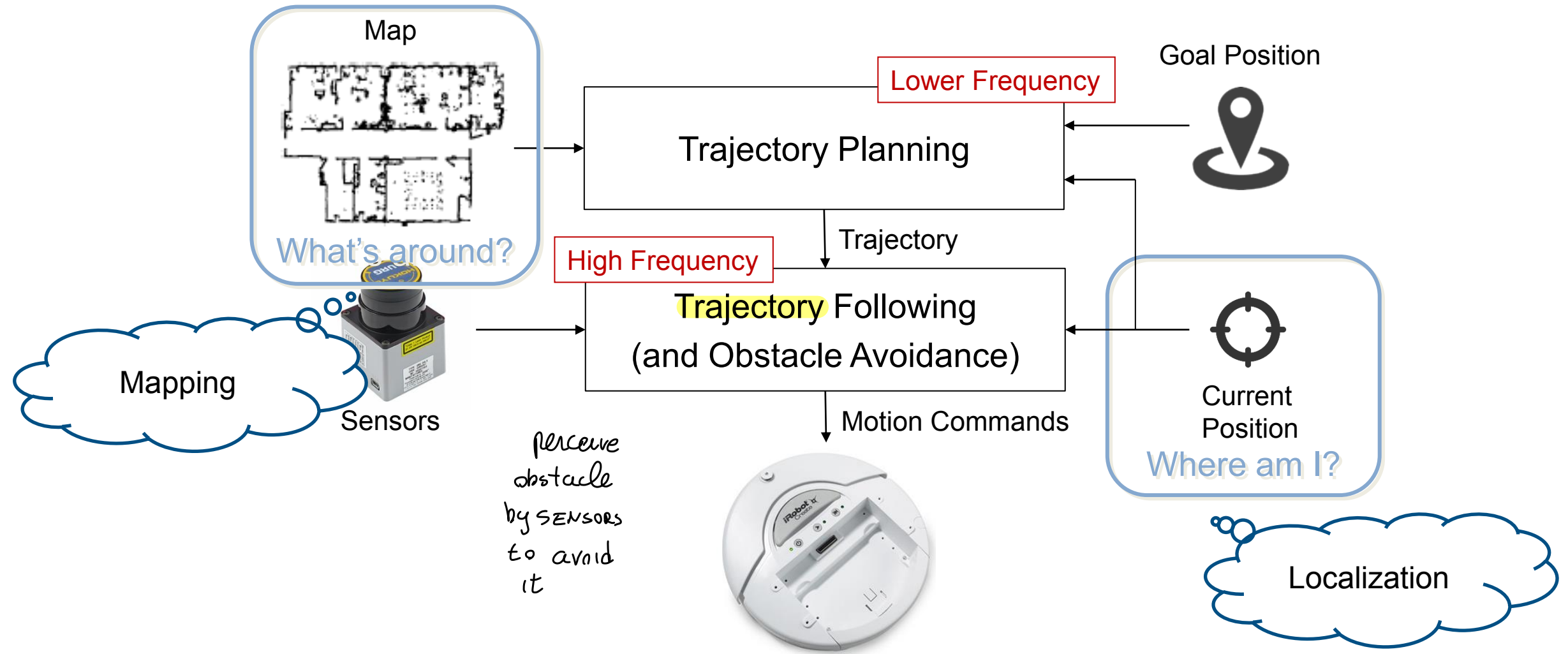
Sensors & Actuators



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A Simplified Sense-Plan-Act Architecture *(Reference architecture)*



to avoid **collision** → know ROBOT POSITION,

{ traj update @ high freq $\approx 100\text{Hz}$
/ position update @ low freq $\approx 0.5\text{Hz}$

• how to compute

ROBOT POSITION → LOCALIZATION

how it works +

↓
implementation

• how to know

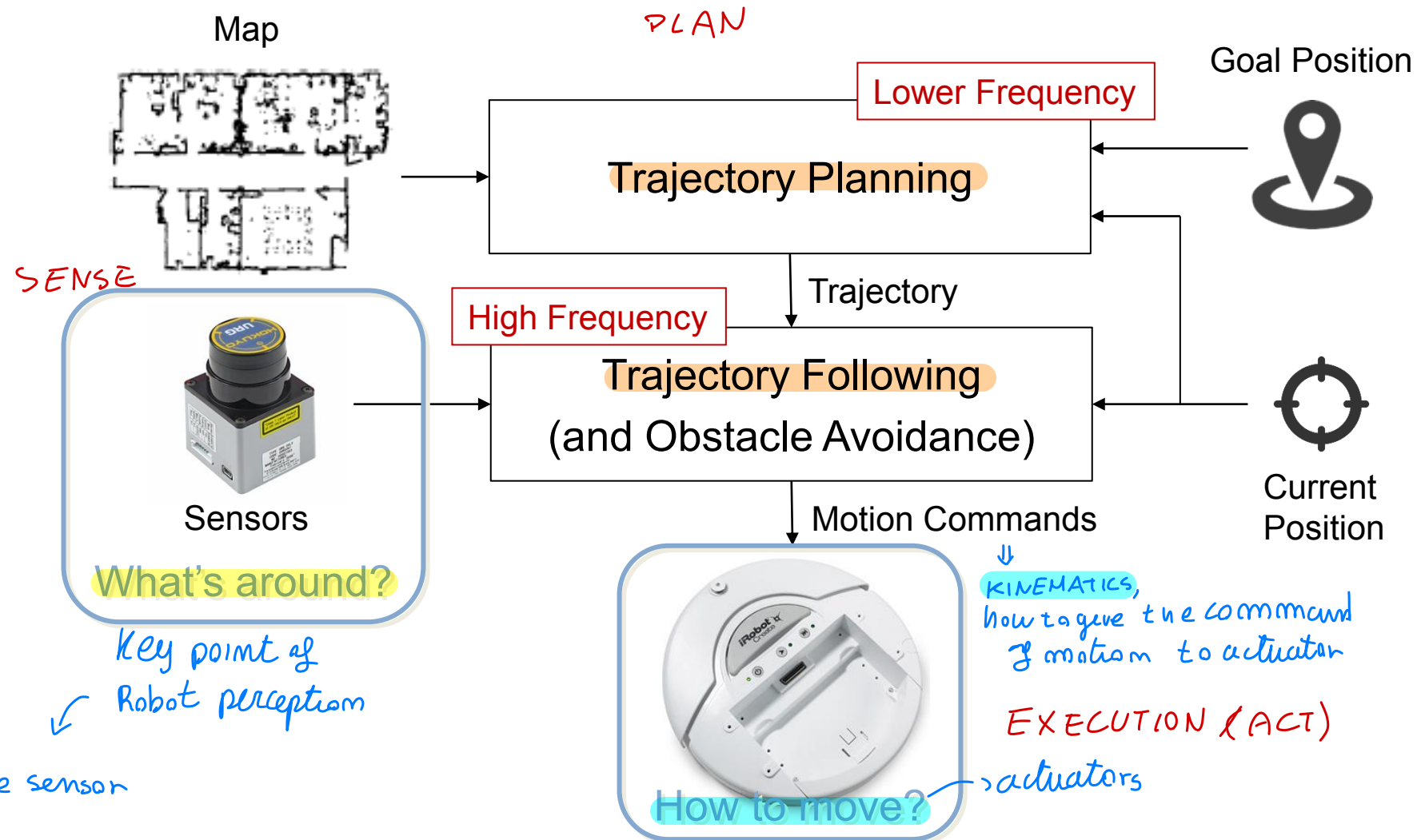
↑
in ROS

map around → MAPPING

Sensor model: probability of getting a certain measurement
in a certain condition

?

A Simplified Sense-Plan-Act Architecture



Different model of the sensor



What does it make an **autonomous robot**?

(ALGORITHMS to decide the better path)

(Sensor) ← Sense - Act - plan
ARCHITECTURE

↳ autonomy by
cycle of sense/
plan/act

Sensors perceive:

- **Internal state of the robot** (proprioceptive sensors) → (EXAMPLE)
 - battery state of charge (the robot has power?)
 - Robot speed / position respect ref plane (INTERNAL respect external Ref)
 - accelerometer look on Fom ROBOT
- **External state of the environment** (exteroceptive sensors) → used to perceive of obstacle in front (LIDAR)/(RADAR)/(CAMERAS)
↑
object AROUND ROBOT ⇒ environment

(part which has an effect on environment)

Effectors modify the environment state

- Match the robot task (e.g., wheels, legs, grippers)

(the GRIP of ROBOT affect env. related to the task) → end effector
↳ specificity of the TASK
GRIPPER

Actuators enable effectors to act (device to actuate)

- E.g., passive actuation, motors of various types

↓
motion between points)
device which make the effectors do the job

- electrical motor
- stepper motor
- pneumatic actuation



Sensors

Algorithms

Actuators

} internal → control Robot action
{ external → detect characteristic external useful for Robot

Type of Actuators

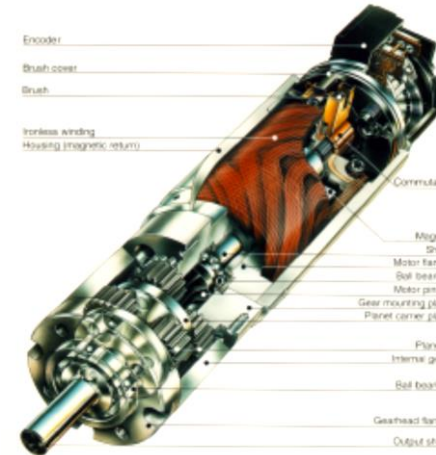


Actuators enable effectors to act

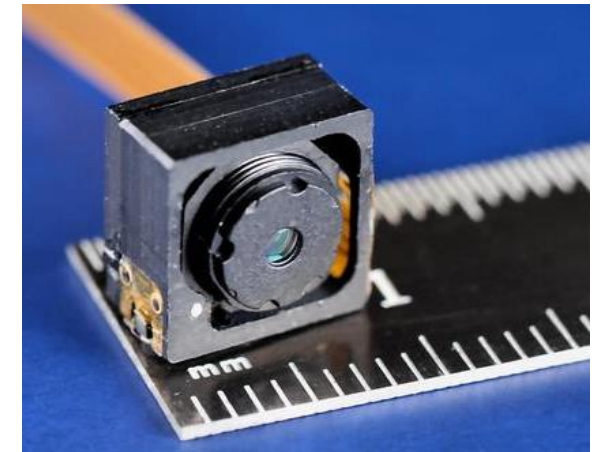
most used, even on car

- Electric motors
- Hydraulics
- Pneumatics
- Photo-reactive materials
- Chemically reactive materials
- Thermally reactive materials
- Piezoelectric materials

*↳ adjust camera
focus for ex*

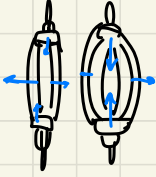


Piezoelectric



- **elect motors**: elect power converted into torque
- **Hydraulic**: (motor/transmission) → used in some applications
(thermal engine) → the device performing the action is hydraulic
controlled by modulating the pressure

- **Pneumatic** controlling air (fluid) like artificial muscle
which shrink



work like muscle... enlarge/shrink etc...

Emulate artificial muscle

(humanoid Robot) only used to pull (shrink)
NOT able to push!

+ others using other physical quantities

(shape memory material, come back to original state by heating)

↓
used to research, to obtain more complex Robotic systems

Most Popular Actuators

First robots used hydraulic and pneumatic actuators

- Hydraulic actuators are expensive, weighing, and hard to maintain (big robots) → *high load* → had to be able to absorb shocks + very fast
- Pneumatic actuators are used for stop-to-stop applications such as pick-and-place (fast actuation)

Long extension in small time (FAST Actuators) → *not used INDUSTRIALLY for motion point to point*

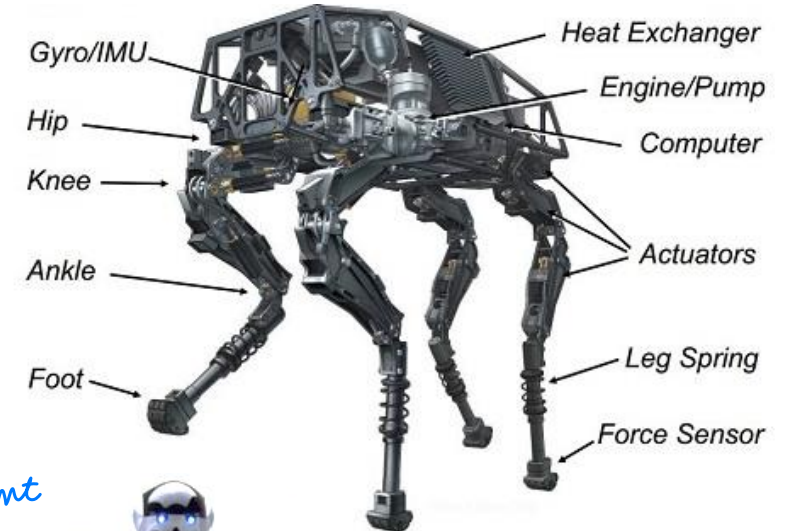
Nowadays most common actuators are electrical motors

- Each joint has usually its own motor (and controller)
- High speed motors are reduced by (elastic) gearing
- They need internal sensors to be controlled
- Stepper motors do not need internal sensors, but when an error occurs their position is unknown

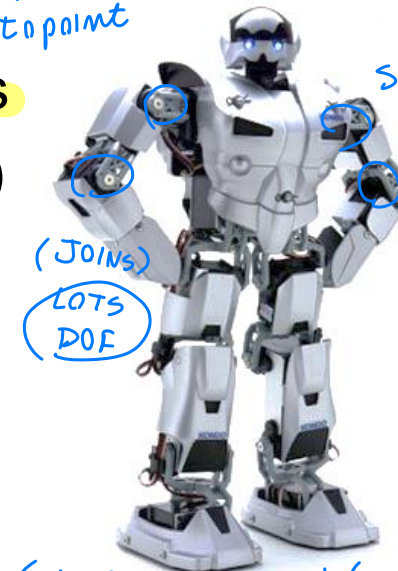
Gear to transmit

*used a lot by
(BOSTON
DYNAMICS)*

*leg with hydraulic act.
+ thermal engine
"Big dog"*



small ROBOTS



(1 elect motor per JOINT)



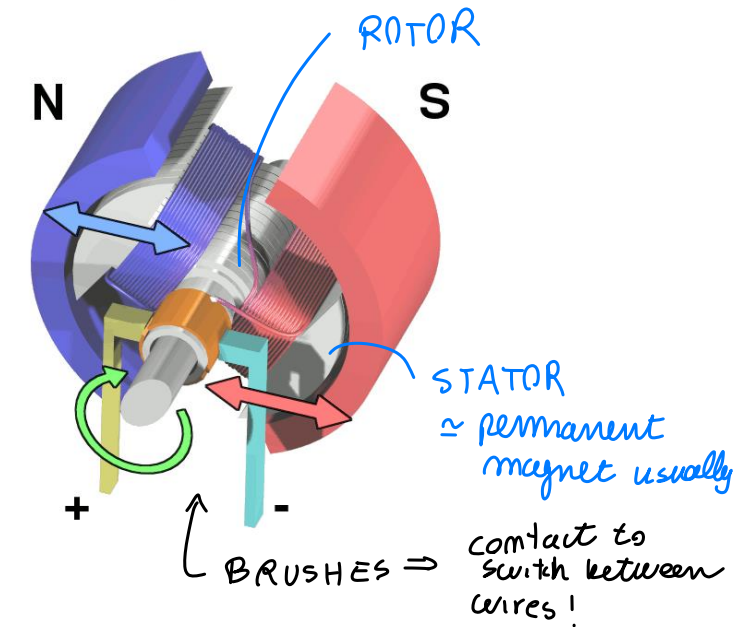
elect mot: We control position / speed
not simply by ON/OFF.. → but with internal control

there are also stepper motor which don't need internal control
(like stepper printer)

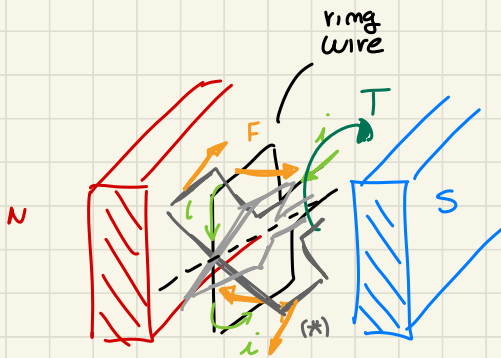
- **Direct Current (DC) motors** *(most used)*
 easy to CONTROL + BUILD
cheap ...
 - Convert electrical energy into mechanical energy
 - Small, cheap, reasonably efficient, easy to use

How do they **work**? *simple architecture*

- Electrical current traverses loops of wires mounted on a rotating shaft
- Loops of wire generate a magnetic field which reacts against the magnetic fields of permanent magnets placed around
- These two magnetic fields push against one another and the armature turns



DC motor $\Rightarrow$ STATIC PART (N/S) permanent magnet



magnetic field inside
magm field pushed
by N attracted by S
and viceversa (F)

$\downarrow$
{ torque generated
by the wire T }

using multiple wires (*)

$\downarrow$
to reduce ripple and have
a smoother Torque

{ keep ROTATING
around ROTATION axis }

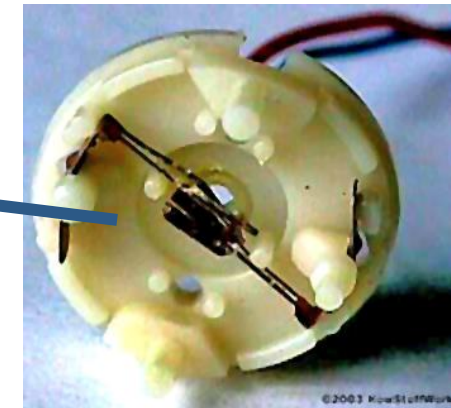
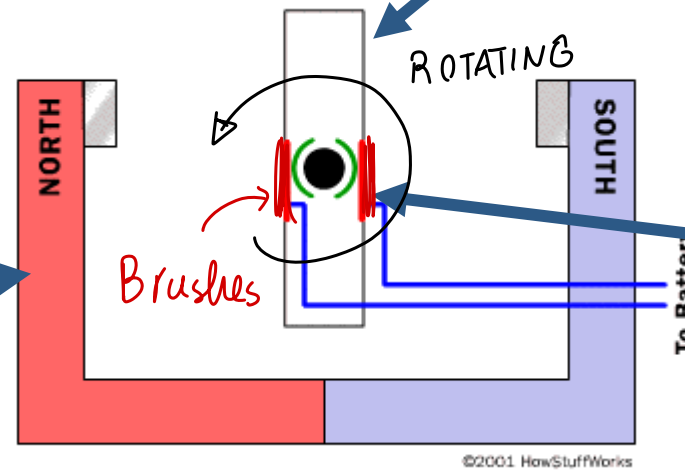
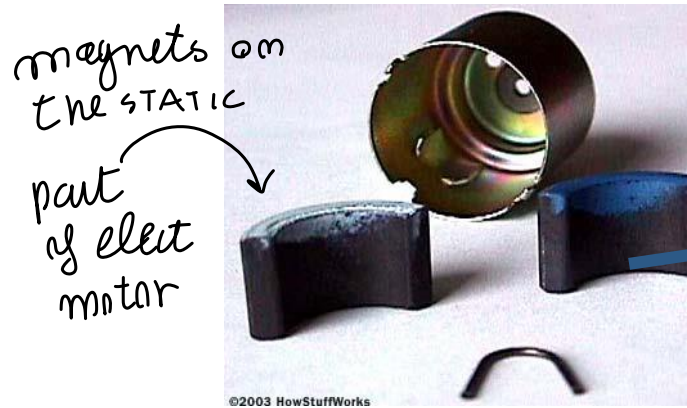
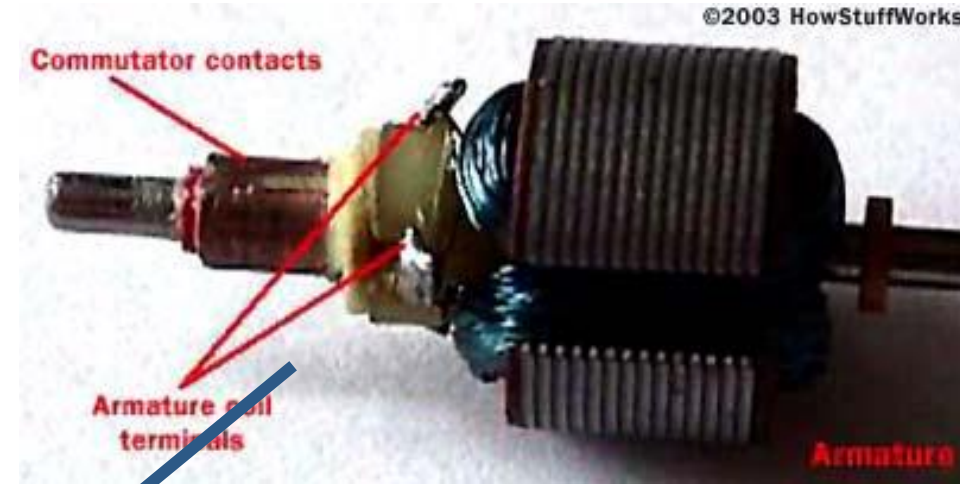
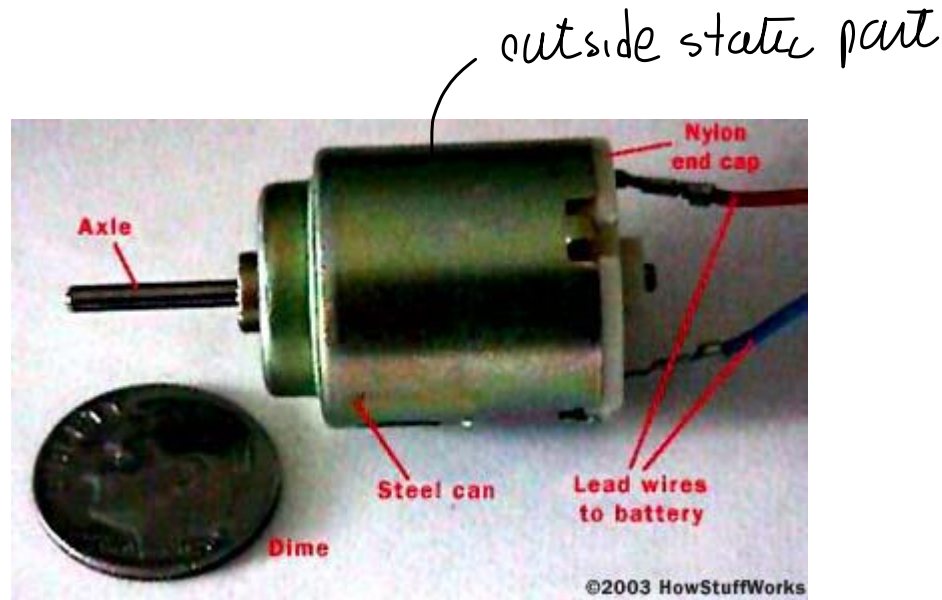
most of elect motors are based on this
principle $\rightarrow$

depending also on How the switch happen

► Sometimes the rotating part can stay outside

DC Motors

Higher charge $\rightarrow$ higher Torque
higher speed



usually this DC motor ROTATE very fast

3K RPM usually $\rightarrow$ T limited but high Ω_m

$\downarrow$
usually GEARINGS (Transmission)

so $\Omega_m \downarrow \Rightarrow T \uparrow$

DC Motors: Brushed and Brushless Motors

usually wires (electromagnet) on stator instead of permanent one
When using brushes: continuous contact!

to have feedback loop you need sensors to measure Ω ... speed/position sensors used

1 **Brushes** used to change magnetic polarity, they're cheap but .. on ROBOTICS

Issues

- Brushes eventually wear out
- Brushes make noise
- Limit the maximum speed
- Hard to cool $\rightarrow$ heat generated by contact
- Limit the number of poles

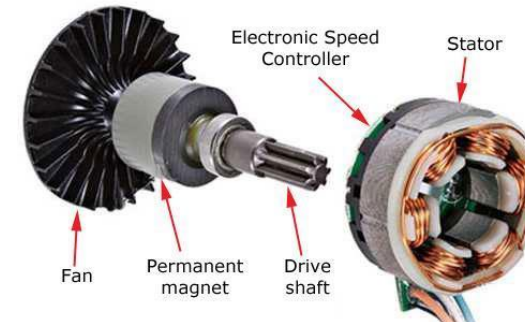
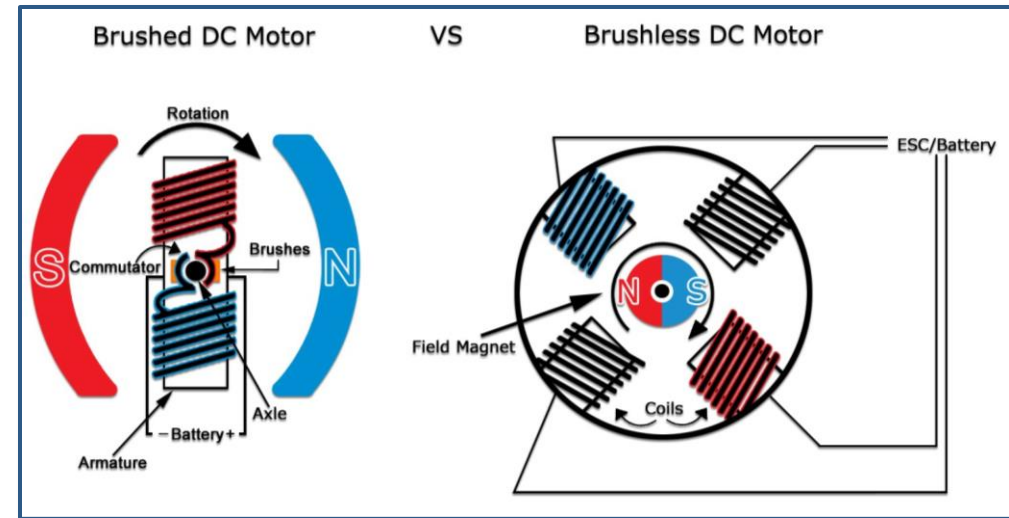
when long life time, the brushes can WEAR too much

$\Downarrow$ to solve Brush Issues

2 **Brushless** motors overcome these problems but they are more expensive

- Brushes are replaced by computer
- Permanent magnets on the rotor
- Electromagnets on the stator

$\uparrow$ to switch between wire you can use a computer control



BRUSHLESS → let magnetic part rotate while wire static
but the force pull/push the ROTOR that follow
the STATOR ↘

outside stator rotate, followed by
↙ rotor inside...

but starting to

ROTATE ⇒ brushless mechanics

magnet rotating and use a computer controller to
switch between wires to let it ROTATE

(Reversed function)

3 **Stepper motors** *(activate for each step, degree of Rotation)*

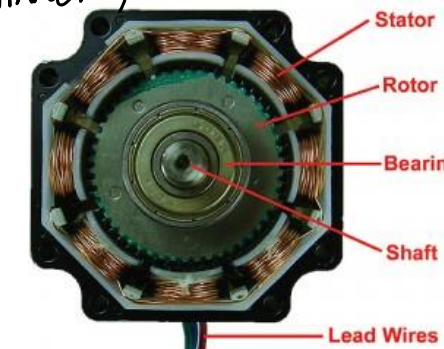
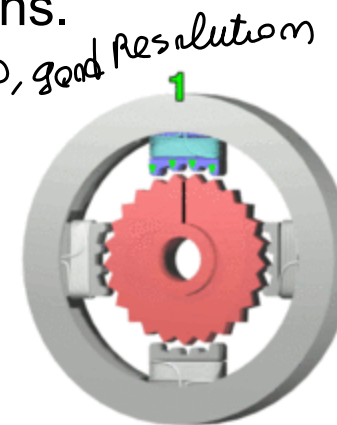
in this case we DON'T need sensors... on small movement
you don't need a sensor here
↓ like brushless motor working..
electromagnet switched to generate one ROTATION STEP
shaft motion one step at a time (+ micro movement) (+ stop motion)

A stepper motor is a brushless, synchronous electric motor that converts digital pulses into mechanical shaft rotations.

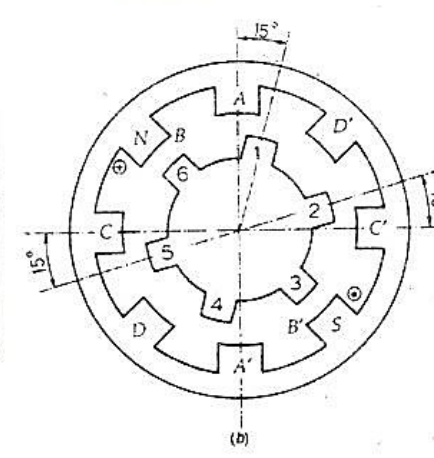
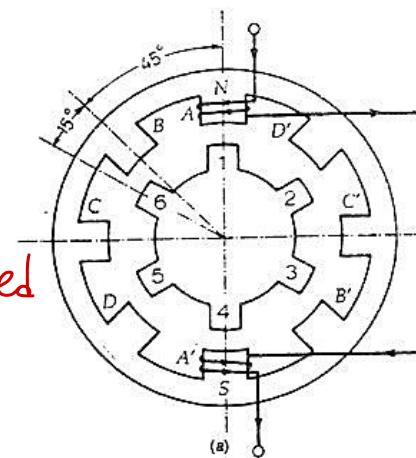
- ✓ Rotation angle proportional to input pulse
- ✓ Full torque at standstill (energized windings)
- ✓ Precise positioning and repeatability
- ✓ Response to starting/stopping/reversing
- ✓ Very reliable (no contact brushes)
- ✓ Allow open-loop control (simpler and cheaper)
- ✓ Allow very low speed synchronous rotation with a load directly coupled to the shaft.
- ✓ Wide range of rotational speeds

- Lot used, cheap, good resolution*
- [NOT for CONTINUOUS MOTION!]*
- ✗ Require a dedicated control circuit → *✓ STEP*
 - ✗ Use more current than D.C. motors → *require more power*
 - ✗ Torque reduces at higher speeds → *Ω limit / No high speed*
 - ✗ Resonances can occur if not properly controlled.
 - ✗ Not easy to operate at extremely high speeds

⦿ NOT very accurate -- you can lose steps



$$\alpha = \frac{N_s - N_r}{N_s N_r} \times 360^\circ$$



Servo Motors

motor with precise position but limited speed

"Servo": specialized motors that can move their shaft to a specific position

- Used in hobby radio control applications
- Measure their own position and compensate for external loads when corresponding to a control signal

sensor measuring shaft position

Servo motors are built from DC motors by adding

- Gear reduction
- Position sensor
- Control electronics

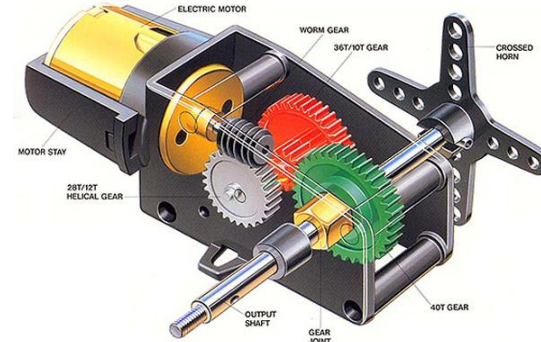
Shaft travel is restricted to 180 degrees but it is enough for most applications

(MOTOR+SENSOR+CONTROLLER)

↑ moves robot to reach desired position

used into ROBOTS
very similar to: COMBINATION of MOTOR+SENSOR
(vehicles radiocontrolled) (position control - actuators)

any joint can be $< 180^\circ$
for humanoid robot
+ position control of JOINT



potentiometer
sensor
+ RETROACTION
(feedback loop
to position
sense)



close a control loop to reach target set-point POSITION

(sometimes can control velocity (RARE))

↓ (Pulse Wave modulation)
PWM signal to control servo motors
(NOT classic PWM on brushless motors)

Servo: has an embedded controller,
PCB inside the system

on servo motor: you can control speed / position with
voltage / current → with nested control loop

Sensors

"Mobile Robots" move on wheels, by electrical motors

Voltage input to let rotate elect motors...

→ how fast they rotate / position

to know where it is moved, control motion ⇒ **ENCODER** : how much rotate

Sensors allow a robot to accomplish complex tasks autonomously

distinctions

Two main categories

- **Internal sensors** (proprioceptive) ①
 - **External sensors** (exteroceptive) ②
- ↑ related to ROBOT
↓ related to ENVIRONMENT

Other classification

- **Passive** (measure physical property) vs **Active sensors** (emitter + detector)
- ↑ collect energy
↓ inject + receive energy



Projector

↓ project pseudo-Random dots... on IR region seen by camera to estimate the scene depth

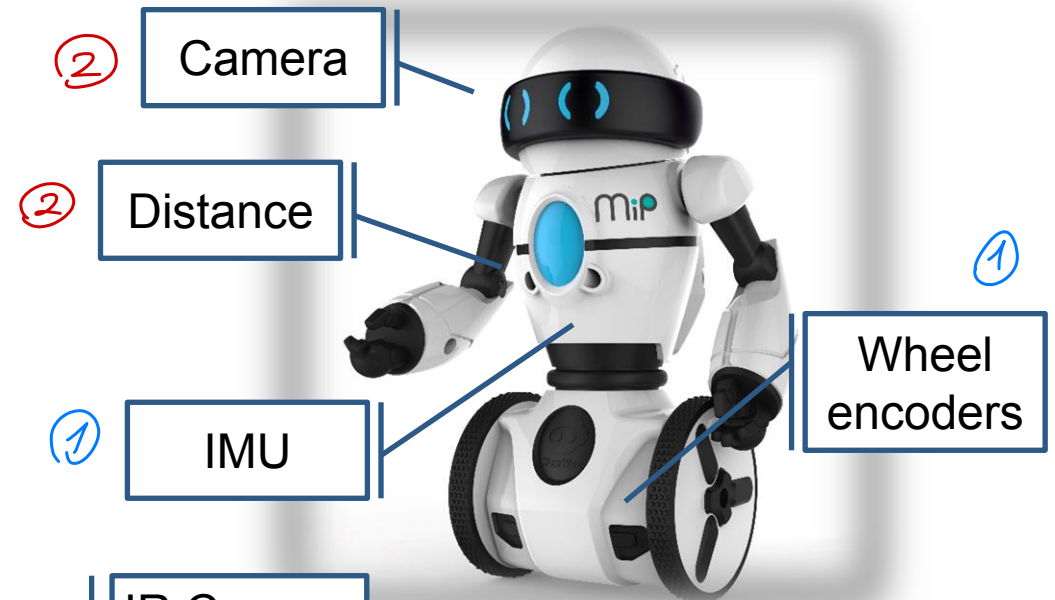


IR Camera

RGB Camera

→ PASSIVE sensor, just sense

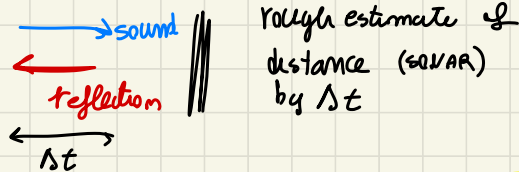
it has a camera INFRARED and RGB (color camera) to collect light



sensor → **Passive** physical property measurement, JUST measure,
like when meas a Temperature I don't need to
do things to measure

→ **Active** do something to measure..

(ex) parking sensors on cars beep when near
⇒ ULTRASOUND sensors



or for example with RADAR... OR on **Thermal sensor**
emission + measurement

usually distance measurements use Active sensors...

Inject energy and reflect it transform into distance

(except for STEREOVISION which collect images and detect distance, PASSIVE)

Encoders

measure position/speed of motors
(counting the stripes they have passed through)
OPTICAL ENCODERS uses stripes encoded

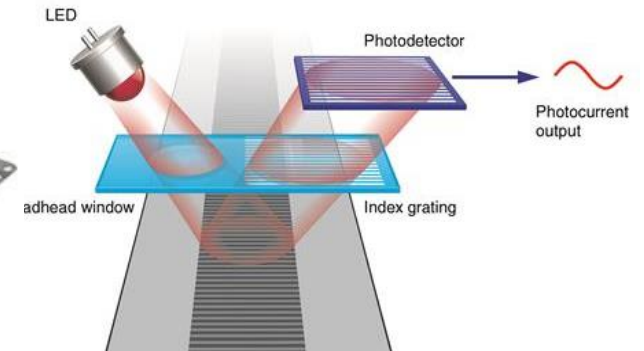
set of bars, with light emitted to measure how many steps you see... to see the holes in front of light... you know how much it moves

black-white hole... light go through and we detect it!

An encoder converts motor/joint rotary motion or position into electronic pulses
knowing Resolution you know motion

Linear encoders

- Consist of a long linear read track, together with a compact read head



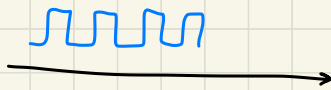
(ROTARY MOVEM.)
⇒ Rotary encoders useful for ROTATING displacements when using Gears -- wheel on stripes

- Both for rotary and linear motion (in conjunction with some mechanism) convert rotary motion into electrical signals
- They can be incremental or absolute

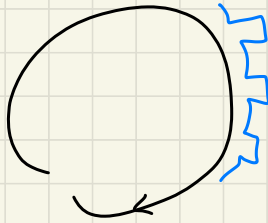
↓ attached on shaft MOTOR to measure rotation



linear



Rotatory



Incremental rotary encoders

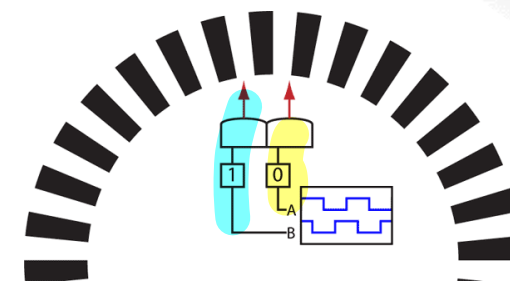
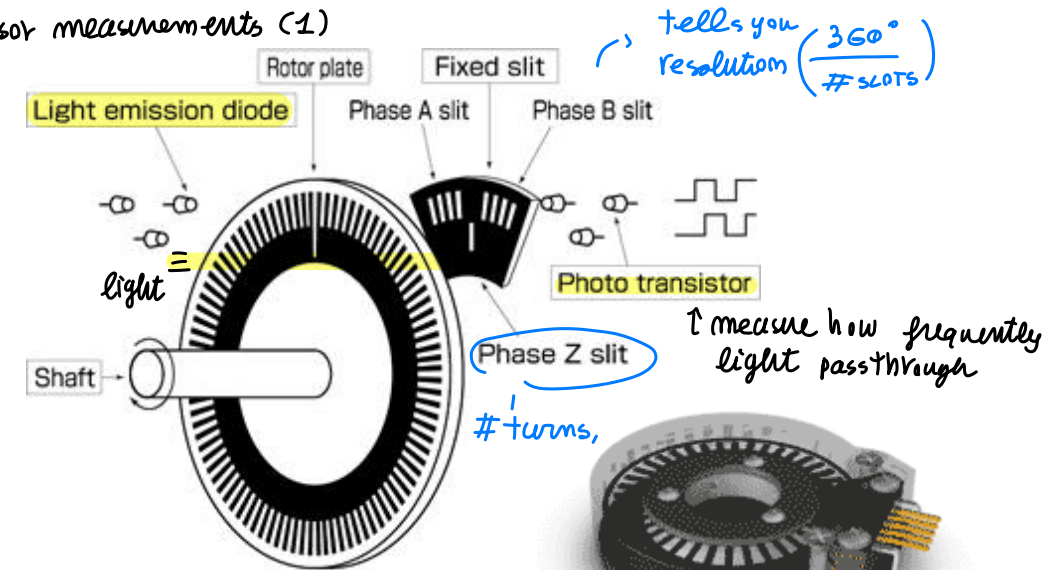
square waves generated while moving. return the degree of motion by the sensor measurements (1)
 and speed depending on frequency of measure square waves
 angular speed / position!

It is based on the photoelectric principle

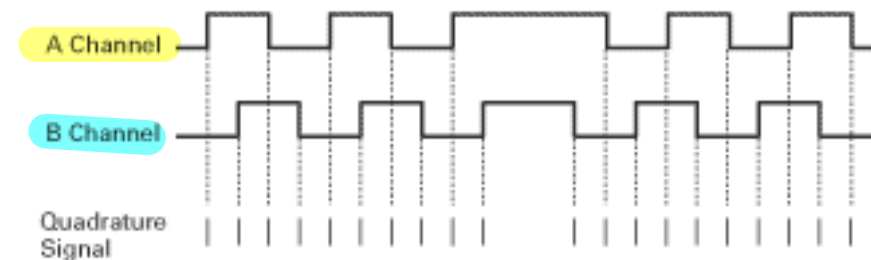
- A disk with two traces (or sensors) where transparent and opaque zones alternate
- The two traces allows to identify rotation direction and increases resolution (quadrature)

Quadrature technique *square waves -- how to get information about ROTATION direction*

- The two signals are shifted by $\frac{1}{4}$ step
- N, is the number of steps, i.e., the number of light/dark zones, per turn
- Resolution is $360^\circ/4N$
 - CCW: 1 1 is followed by 1 0
 - CW: 1 1 is followed by 0 1



You use 2 square waves shifted by $\frac{1}{4}$ period



2 channels A/B

(PROS)

↓ you get 4 events $\forall$ slot $\Rightarrow$ so get 4x time
previous resolution

4x resolution with 2 channels ↓

↳ quadruple resolution (accurate)

- depending on rotation direction it changes the overall square form

↳ measure rotation

- telling $\angle$ angle you can count $\Rightarrow$ reference respect $\angle$ position counting ticks from origin...

↓
you have to set up on ZERO

← we use this increment. encoder to measure speed

↳ if you need also

↓ POSITION

ZERO techniques to

go @ $\angle$ ORIGIN each time you switch ON/OFF

$\Rightarrow$ solve this with

absolute ROTARY encoder

Absolute rotary encoders

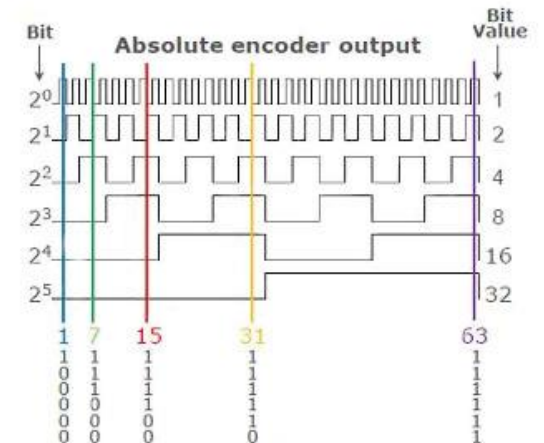
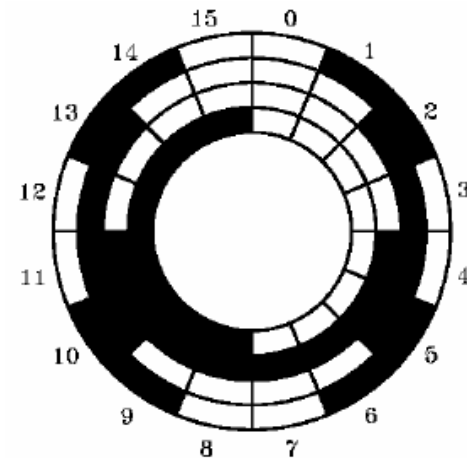
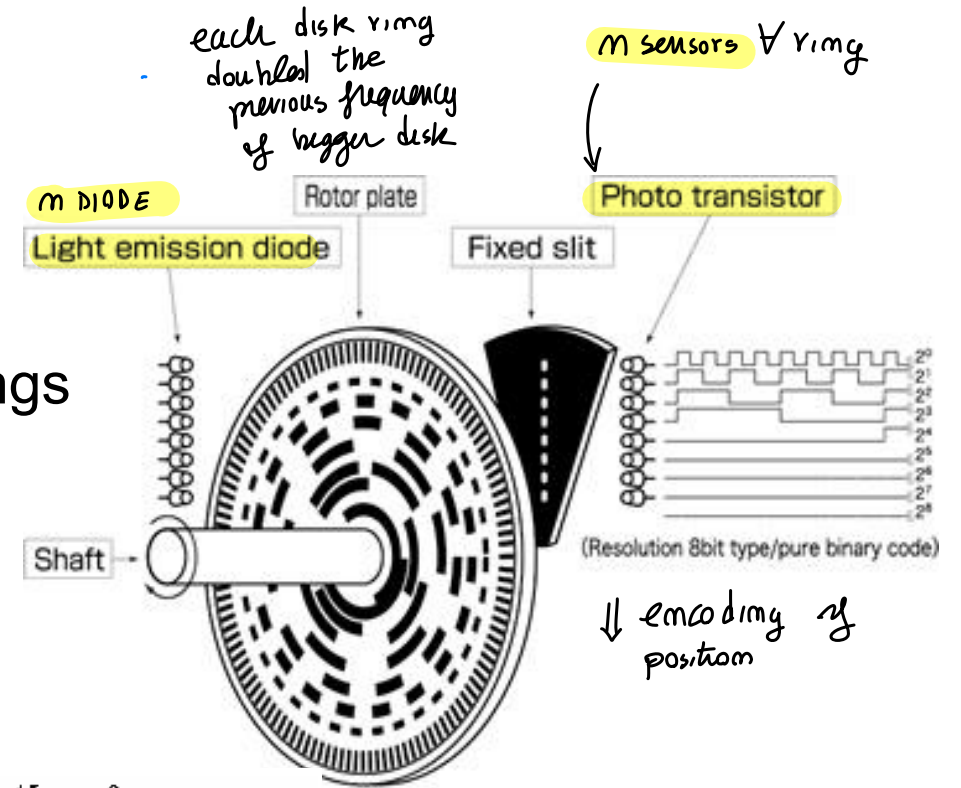
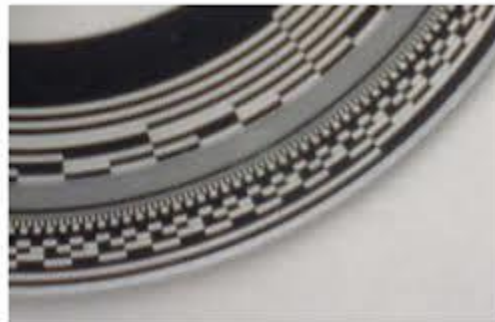
same principle of incremental one but more holes and different frequency & circle

you get in total 2^m possible angle (Binary)

The disk encodes a position

- Transparent and opaque areas on concentric rings
- For an N-bit word there are N rings
- Absolute resolution: $360^\circ/2^N$
- In robotic applications at least $\approx 0,1^\circ$ resolution
12 rings are used ($360^\circ/4096$)
- Binary codes with single variations, i.e., Gray code, are used to avoid ambiguities

↑ shaffle order of holes
QUITE good position,
not used in industrial
application



Gray coding $\rightarrow$ so only 1 bit changes between...

so for 1 bit error only 1/10 angle error!

only 1 bit changing $\Rightarrow$ only 1 error

While of binary error $\Rightarrow$ IF you make error
on significant BIT of classical DIGITAL CODING
you get HIGH error!



While with Grey coding each number
change only 1 bit ... $\Rightarrow$ small error & revelation
of error on measure

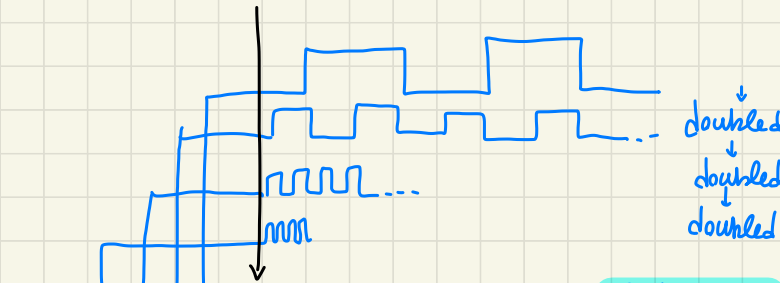
shifting by some
bits... resolution
change chosen properly

Wheel moving by
Read velocity

$\uparrow$ easy by ENCODER

$\downarrow$
estimate of position...

Read vertically the bit to decode it



GRAY CODE

most internal 1/2 black, 1/2 white
it double the frequency but
in a complex way

1st: half black, half white

2nd: 4 pieces, Gray coding
double freq.

out of 4 bit $\rightarrow$ 2B, 2W

apparently it seems NOT
doubled $\rightarrow$ in Reality there is
a doubling of bits

each sector
referred to a STRIP
of LED

L,
Coding
with a
table of
access

$\Rightarrow$

Table



memory
access to
table to
assign the
corresponding
displacement

Distance perception: time-of-flight telemeter

↓ distance sensors

↳ extracting
for MAPPING/PERCEPTION
to avoid obstacles

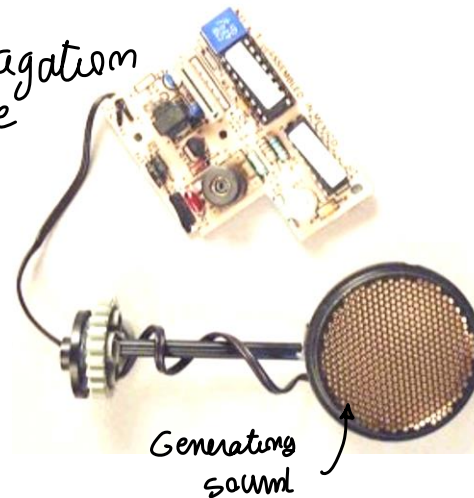
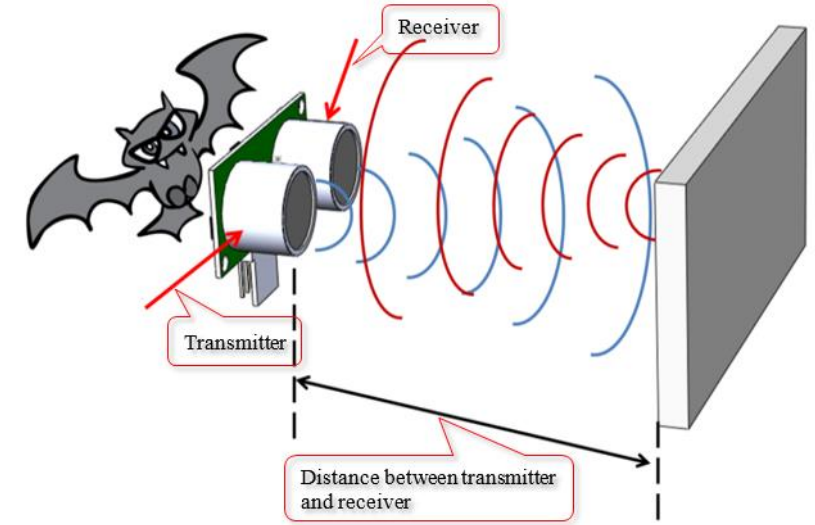
SONAR simpler device...

It measures the time between the emitter produces the signal and the detector receives its reflection

- Distance covered by the signal is $2d$
- Time of flight is $\Delta T = 2d/c$

Acoustic waves are used (although light is possible)

- Low speed: $v=340 \text{ m/s}$ (sound speed)
- Low directionality: $20 - 40^\circ$ (beam propagation of wave)
- Polaroid ultrasonic sensors (sonar)
 - range 0.3 – 10m
 - accuracy 0.025m
 - cone opening 30°
 - frequency 50 KHz (sound frequency)



The signal is largely affected by noise with significant reflections ...

Sonar: measure the time to go and come back...
so measuring the distance

↓
ACUSTIC

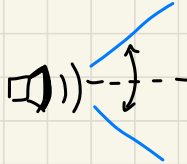
↓
ULTRA
SOUND

easy to generate and detect reflected sound

{ ACTIVE
SENSOR }
↓
you send
sound energy
to environm.

sound propagates as a cone

come back signal
inside that cone...



(called)

- "POLAROID sonar" because used on polaroid to adjust the focus depending on people distance

you need fast measure when near...
if FAR obstacle you have to wait

there is a certain
frequency of update
to re-send the signal



Cheap BUT With lots issues...

not used in car sensor of parking

(20cm ÷ 2m) range of usage

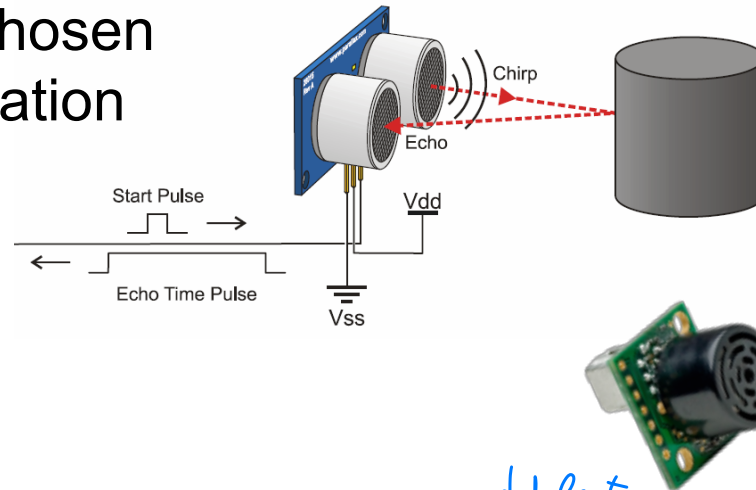
to see big
objects

⇒
Bad quality, Bad resolution

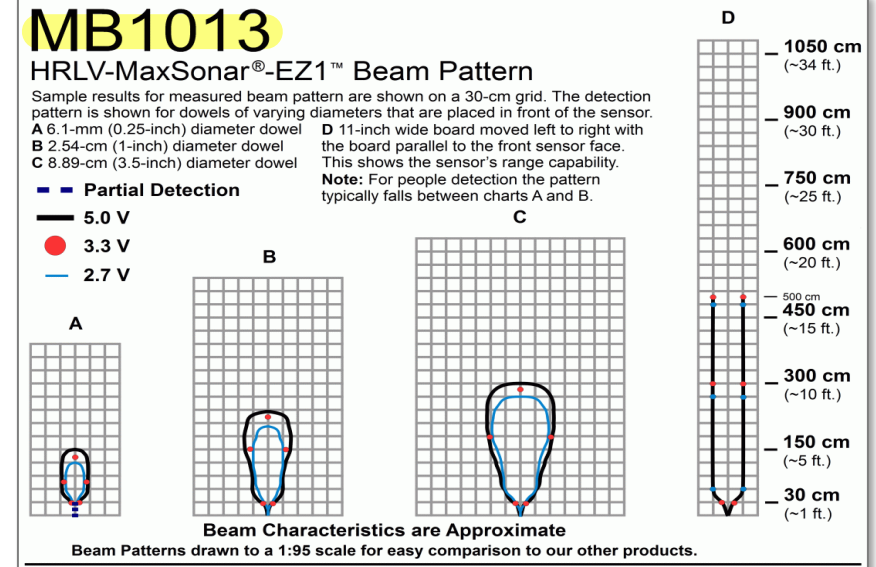
Issues with sonars *(30° angle is an issue)*

ULTRASOUND → has a certain range!

The range should be chosen according to the application



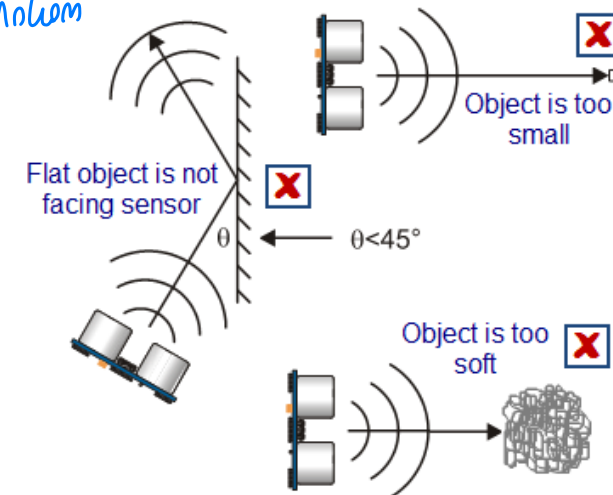
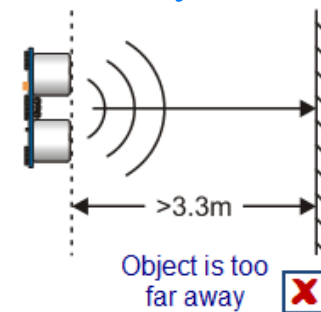
range ≈ 30 cm with lots Voltage



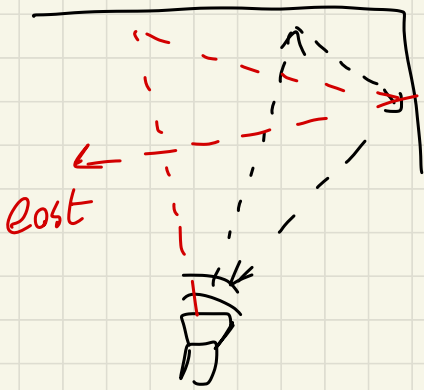
PROBLEMS

They do not work in all conditions

- **Sampling frequency trade-off** *mom readable too often... because of sound motion*
- **Reflections** against walls *↳ between freq and distance*
- **Small objects** *↳ sound bounces*
- **Soft objects** *↳ hard to detect when reflect less*
↳ DON'T Reflect



Rooms may look larger than expected at corners!



longer than
1st expected...
bad estimation
OR lose of the signal

sometimes sensors are NOT
enough Good! → NOT for MAPPING...

[depends on final
task]!

a mapping with
sensor can be
very bad!

⇒ More
Reliability!

move away from
usage of sound... different
kind of energy
light sensors ⇒

Distance perception: reflective optosensors

conditions where Sonars are NOT enough.

send $\rightleftharpoons$ receive light. BUT this is high speed, NOT measurable Δt

INFRARED / Sharp sensor

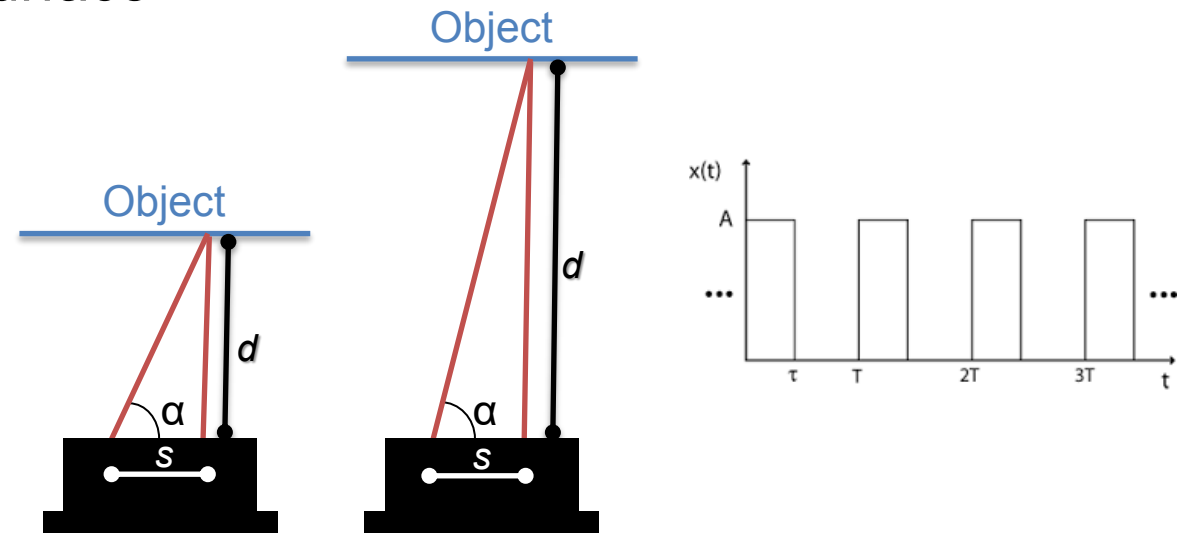
Reflective optosensors are active sensors (e.g., SHARP IR Sensors)

- Emitter: a source of light, e.g., LED (light emitter diode) or IR (infra red)
- Detector: a light detector, e.g., photodiode or phototransistor

It uses triangulation to compute distance

- Emitter casts a beam of light on the surface
- The detector measures the angle corresponding to the maximum intensity of returned light
- Being s the distance between the emitter and the detector

$$d = s \cdot \tan \alpha$$



send laser and detect @ which angle the beam is reflected

TRIANGULATION!



measure the $\tan(\alpha)$ distance ratio and reconstruct distance!

based on d , s parameter and α angle



sensors working on IR domain

Infrared: silicon excited... so with CMOS easy to be detected

• eyes not excited by IRs → people don't see it

IR ⇓ received by sensors

Sun is an IR source always present, so

you try to detect pulses



pulse encoding

• very cheap, same ultrasound

Don't work:

- mirrors
- glass door
- black obj

} reflective surface problematic!

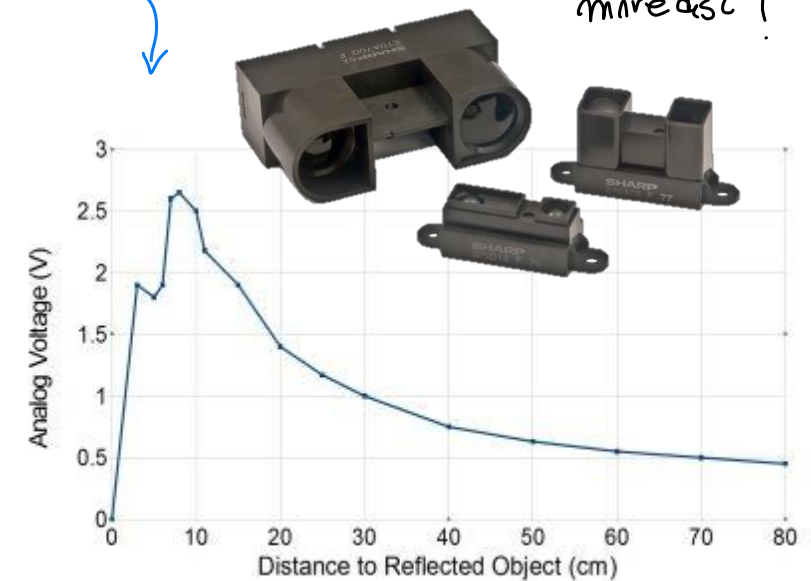
Issues with reflective optosensors

↓ angle issue... short range ambiguity!

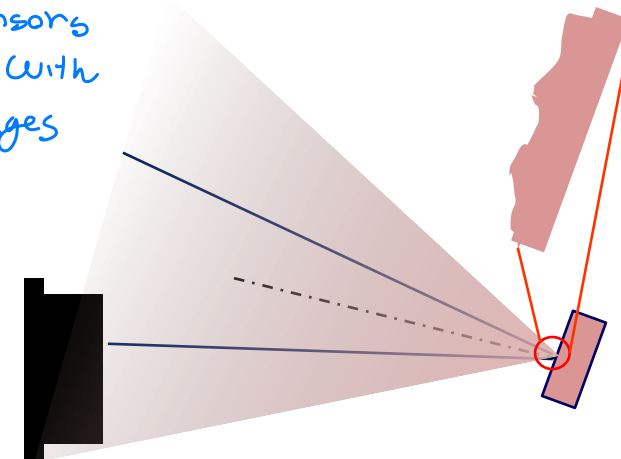
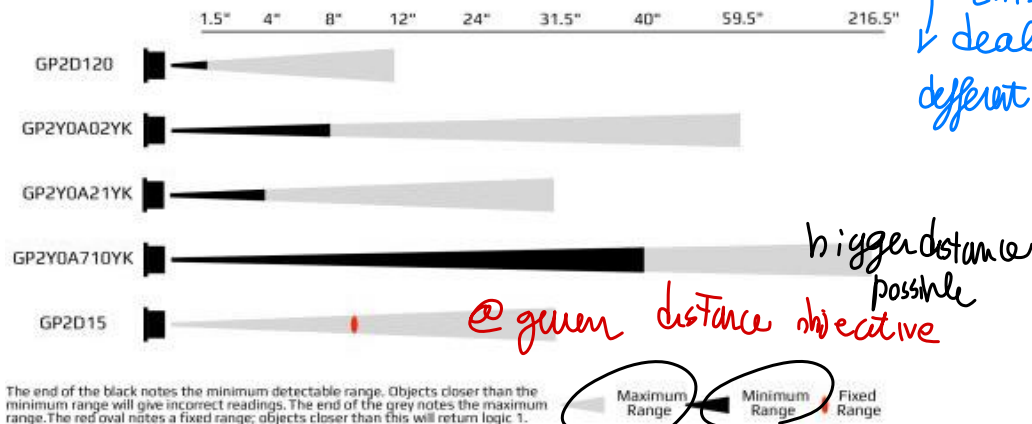
Infrared sensors are relatively cheap and robust but ...

- Non linear characteristics which need to be calibrated
- Have an ambiguity for short range (should be placed in the robot)
- Have fixed ranges / opening angles (requires proper selection)
- May suffer reflections ... sometimes

usually mounted inside Robots to increase distanceable, so it measure mindist!
to be sure of close object, where this require tooV...



you can by
↓ this sensors
dealing with
different ranges



of the sensor



when close object, narrow spot

REFLECTION! how light come back ...
unless mirrors some light
always come back

base sensors...

IR camera to measure 3D distance of object...

↓

Send set / cloud of points and read this → many IR
measured by multiple points

↓

pattern... estimate

based on TRIANGULATION of many points

pseudo-Random points cloud with unique shape found by camera

{ formula based on triangulation,
Respect a ref plane where collecting points.. }

LOT used on ROBOTICS sensors!

changed robotics
which had to use stereo
camera etc...

you project.. stereo
with decoded image to see

Kinect: one of the
most used
sensor! RGB camera also!

(several producing it like Intel...)

Some problems outdoors due to sun IR, very noisy
but some problems on mirrors, glass etc...

Distance perception: **time-of-flight camera**

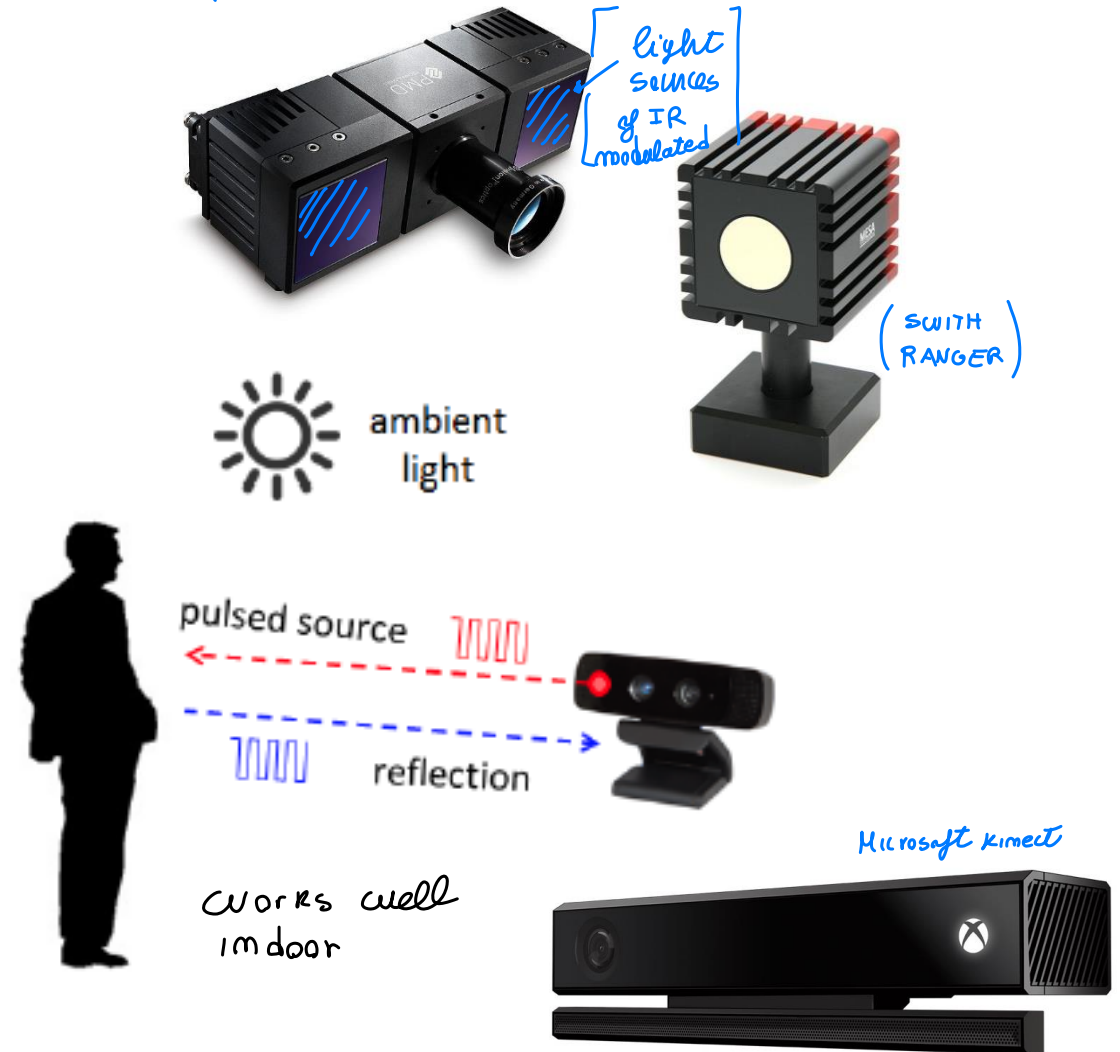
even with prime sense CLOSE --- respect TRIANGULATION of Kinect like
light sensor $\Rightarrow$ other distance techniq. USE light AS SONAR

3D time-of-flight (TOF) cameras

- Illuminate the scene with a modulated light source and observe reflected light
- Phase shift between illumination and reflection is translated to distance

Some issues exist with these sensors

- Illumination is from a solid-state laser or a near-infrared ($\sim 850\text{nm}$) LED
- An imaging sensor receives the light and converts the photonic energy to electrical current
- Distance information is embedded in the reflected component. Therefore, high ambient component reduces the signal to noise ratio (SNR).



send light beam and measure it required
↳ count time required to come back!

BUT high light speed! You modulate light
so that shift of returned
light is proportional to dist.

you measure
phase shift of In/Out

measure reflection → accurate travel time by phase shift!

usually you use LIDAR, SONAR or others

Lot of energy on wide spectrum

filter in front of camera to measure energy

most advanced Ranging device..

OUTDOOR not very accurate! because of

noise environment → use light source more
powerful

{ single camera
+
AI (deep
learn) }

geometrically work by experience
to build a distance mapping
train the model reconstruct distance
↓
monocular distance estimation

with ML you also need to understand the object-type
and guess the distance !

↓

interesting training model
unsupervised !

all seen sensors work indoor

outdoor → energy required high

⇒

2 solutions { stereo camera, collect 2 images
and triangulation for distance ⇒
• not light source → LIDAR
sensor

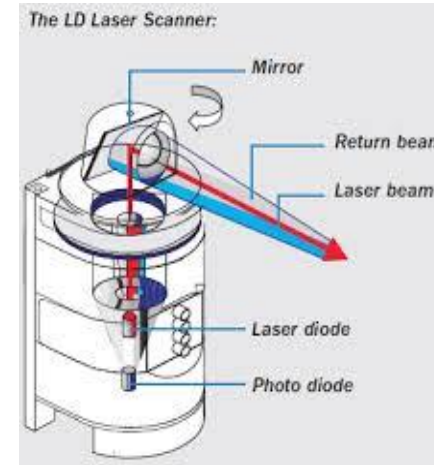
Distance perception: Laser Range Finder

work as a single beam time of flight sensor..
measuring it to come back → lots energy sent

LIDAR (light version of Radar)
LASER RANGE FINDER

Lasers are definitely more accurate sensors

- 180 ranges over 180° (up to 360 °)
- 1 to ~~64~~ planes scanned 128
- 10-75 scans/second
- <1cm range resolution
- Max range up to ~~50-80~~ m 300m
- Problems only with mirrors, glass, and matte black.



< 1000 €



~ 6000 €



~ 40.000 €



> 80.000 €

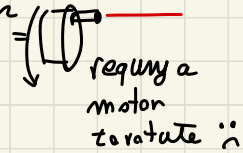
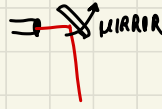
first
one on
Google
Cars

Nowaday
for 500 €!



Lidar

→ you can have multiple laser but
because of cost I can rotate laser
OR rotate the light
by a mirror



you can move
fast the light
LOTS measurements

Very accurate! ROBUST (not energy)

all OUTDOOR vehicles WORK WITH LIDAR Reliable / accurate

not so costly sensors now, firstly HIGH cost!

- you can have multiple
plane of mirrors scanned
by device

→ 128 planes: 2M points/sec!

Now • small cheap sensors!

• more expensive industrial

LIDAR is expensive respect the others!

↑
data coming from Lidars is a lot used
for mapping / Localization

(!) dust / snow... reflect the light! bad working
due to meteor

(RADAR) based on basic principle...

more properly → you can use doppler effect
to measure also velocity (speed) of obj
(used in cars)

BUT noisy signal and expensive

NO used for ROBOTS → research on
Autonomous drive
because see through rain, snow, etc..

Position sensors (outdoor) → indoor / outdoor

use GPS, GLONASS satellite for positioning

Outdoor position can be measure by a "Global Navigation Satellite System"

- Several constellations exist (GPS, GLONASS, Beidou, Galileo, ...)

(american satellite)

{american implementation of GPS}

Global Positioning System (GPS)

- 24 satellites orbit the Earth twice a day
- They synchronously emit location and time
- Receiver compares transmitted and arrival times
- At least 4 sensors must be perceived
- Accuracy is about 2.5m@2Hz (20 cm DGPS)

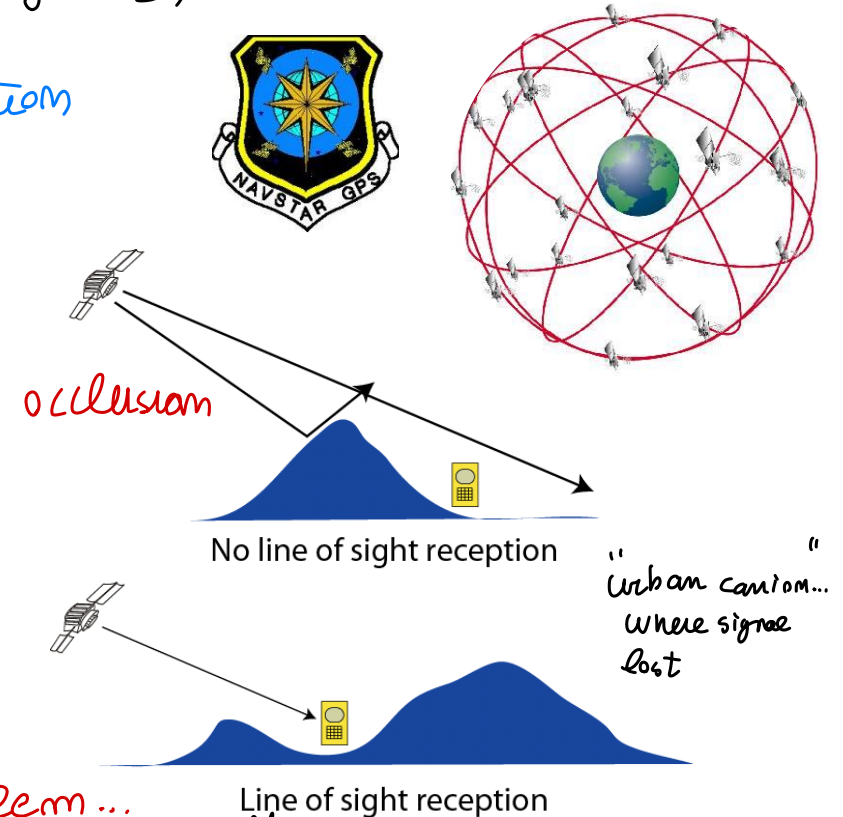
periodically position

Several issues

- Do not work indoor, underwater, or in urban canyon
- Need line of sight reception
- Suffer multiple paths and reflections

like so many problem...

longer distance due to multiple path reflection or lost signal



Know your position knowing the position
of satellite... the receiver from
satellite distance can tell where is
the receiver!

DM Normal
conditions → good signal!
with high accuracy

DM Real time kinematics → 2cm error
sensor HIGH COST!
good precision

Inertial sensor used for ROBOTS measuring forces, acceleration, inertia



Gyroscopes

- Angular velocities

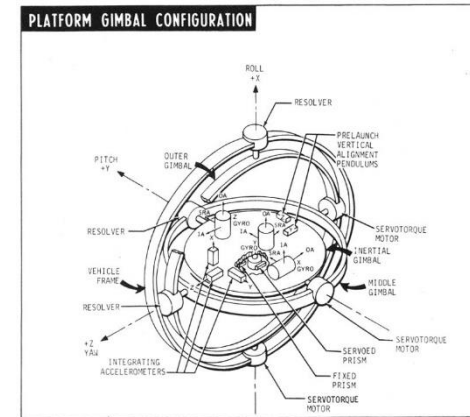
Accelerometers

- Linear accelerations
- Gravitational vector

Magnetometers/compass

- Earth magnetic field vector

ST-124 Inertial Guidance Platform used in the Saturn V, (1960s) for SATURN Nasa mission



nowdays
cheap sensor



An Inertial Measurement Unit (IMU) fuses gyroscopes, accelerometers and magnetometers to provide full 6DoF pose estimate

Inertial measurements integration (e.g., to compute position) cumulate errors and drifts significantly over time, especially with cheap MEMS technology ...

Noise/accuracy very different!



Not used for DRONES thanks to control of
altitude, rotation

@ LOWER COST than expensive Gyroscope

Tactile Sensors → for safety! when hitting it stops!
thanks to "switches"

artificial SKINS

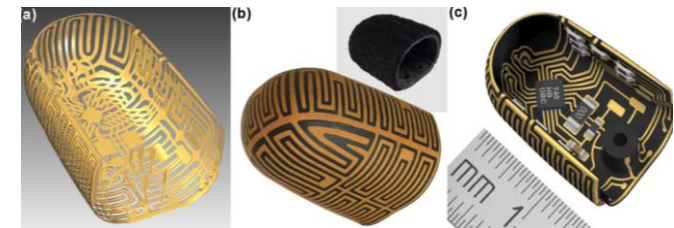
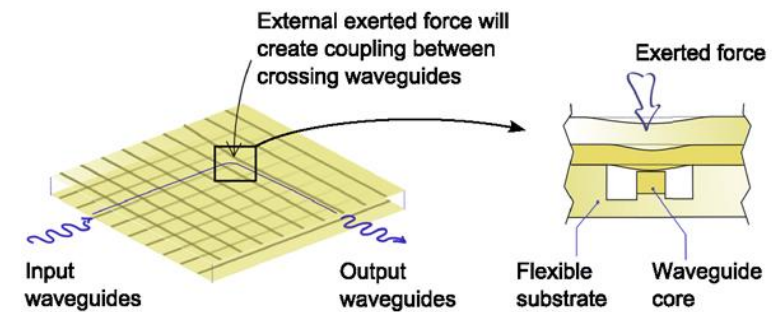
OR CAPACITORS (like on smart phone)

These sensors are used for manipulation purposes

Two main categories

measuring contact, or
array of sensors to
know where touching

- Binary
 - realized by switches
 - placed on the fingers of a manipulator
 - may be arranged in arrays (bumpers)
 - on the external side to avoid obstacles
- Analogical (real valued)
 - soft devices that produce a signal proportional to the local force
 - a spring coupled with a shaft
 - soft conductive material that change resistance with compression
 - measure also movements tangential to the sensor surface



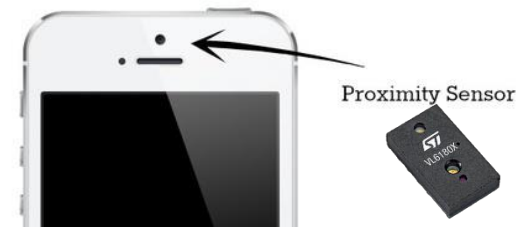
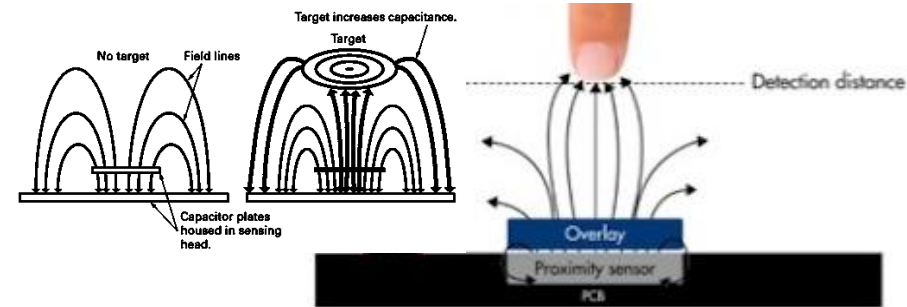
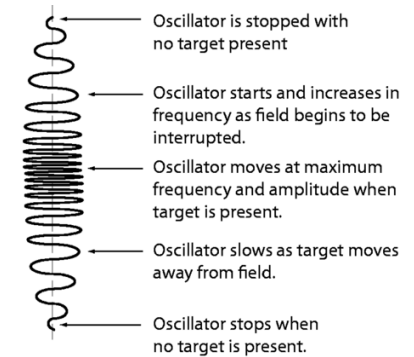
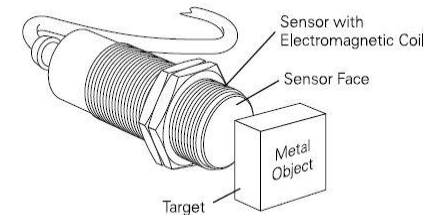
Proximity Perception (short range distance)

Measure the presence of objects within a specified distance range

- Used to grasp objects and avoid obstacles

Several technologies:

- Ultrasonic (low cost)
- Inductive (ferromagnetic materials at distance $< \text{mm}$)
- Hall effect (ferromagnetic materials, small, robust, & cheap)
- Capacitive (any object, binary output, high accuracy when calibrated for a particular object)
- Optical (infrared light, binary or real valued)



Distance Sensor

Mapping Sensors → see obstacles, ... computer vision
image analysis